

FAQs

Secure your Outlook Express

Q, I use Outlook Express to manage my Hotmail account. As my computer is also used by others, I want to know if there is any way in which I can password protect or hide my inbox from public view?

Sidhartha Mohapatra



Manage identities and set passwords to secure your account in Outlook

A Outlook Express does have a facility to manage users, to access it go to **File > Identities > Manage Identities**. Here, you have two alternatives—you can create a new identity or use the default identity.

If you create a new identity, you will have to set up your Hotmail account again. To secure your identity click on **Properties > Require a password**. As soon as you click the checkbox a window appears for the new password. Enter your password and your Outlook Express is secure. It is important to

remember that instead of the normal exit, you have to click Exit and Log Off Identity in the File menu.

Tired fans

Q, I have assembled my own PC, it consists of a Pentium 4 processor on an original Intel motherboard with 128 MB SD RAM and a 40 GB hard disk. One day the computer just shut down normally, but refused to start up again. It started after an hour, but hung after 10 minutes. On opening the cabinet, I observed that the fans (both the SMPS and the processor fan), were not working properly. They were starting and stopping unpredictably. What is the problem and how do I solve it?

Vijay

A You have done a good job of troubleshooting. On first thought, dust seems to be the culprit—quite often the fan's ball-bearings jam due to the dust. As a result is that the fan doesn't work properly and causes the machine to function abnormally.

If dust isn't the culprit, get the SMPS checked by a professional engineer. Since both fans are behaving unpredictably, the SMPS might not be able to supply enough power. If a fan doesn't work properly, the temperature in your machine rises, which

in turn causes the machine to act up.

Cleaning the fans and fixing the SMPS, will solve your problems.

Hard disk: on/off?

Q, I am running Windows Me and have noticed the option of turning off the hard disk in Power Management. What exactly is the purpose of turning off the hard disk? In what specific cases should the hard disk not be turned off? What happens if the hard disk turns off while an MS Word window is open? Can it cause any harm to the system?

Bharat Bhatnagar

A The main purpose of power management is to save power. This benefits us in two ways—reduced electricity bills and an increase in life expectancy for peripherals. There would be no data loss, even if the hard disk shuts off automatically. As soon as you use the system the hard disk will pick up from where it left off. One can set the power management to STR (suspend to RAM) from the BIOS. This option causes all the data to be stored in the RAM, and switches off all the peripherals in the system except the RAM and the CPU fan. Power Management does not harm the machine, in fact it reduces the strain on the devices and thereby increases their life.



Convert audio tapes into MP3s using MusicMatch Jukebox

A To do this, you will have to get a Line-On/Line-Out cable. The cable is connected from the line-out of the audio player to the Line-In port of the soundcard. To

record, you should use decent sound recording software, such as SoundForge or MusicMatch Jukebox. Once the songs are on your computer, you can burn them onto a CD. You can also refer to our October 2002 issue, where we conducted a workshop on converting audio cassettes into MP3s. There you will find step-by-step instructions on how to transfer songs from a cassette to a PC.

DirectX misbehaving

Q, I have a P4 1.7 GHz computer, 128 MB DDR RAM running Windows XP. I have a problem running my games. I tried the DirectX diagnostic troubleshooting tool, and found that there is some sort of DirectX error. When I ran the DirectX3D test, a message is displayed saying, "You cancelled the test by pressing a key", even though I never touched any key. I installed DirectX 8.1 from one of the earlier Digit CDs, but even that didn't help. I tried to repair Windows XP, which solved the problem, but only for

a few days. I have Windows XP and Windows 2000, and the problem persists with both the operating systems. Please help me solve this problem.

Suman

A Everything depends on the graphics card you have, and the games you wish to play. An on-board graphics card is normally not recommended. As you have a problem with DirectX, you should be trying installing DirectX version 9 instead of DirectX 8. You can download it from <http://www.microsoft.com/windows/directx/downloads/drx90.asp>.



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sos@jasubhai.com
or write to Digit,
D-222/2, TTC Industrial Area, MIDC,
MIDC, Nerul, Navi Mumbai-400 706,
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